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General Comment

While machine learning has a place in our world, generative AI does not.

Generative AI is corporate malfeasance on a truly grand scale; it enables the theft of work from working artists everywhere, compensates them for next-to-nothing, and (when left in the wild) complicates literally every part of electronic life by its very existence. The presence of a credible picture (however anatomically incorrect) of some animal will be used as a reference, with its user not realizing it was generated by machine. GenAI is notoriously bad at answering questions, and in fact in when used in health systems, it frequently fails to pick up even the most obvious injuries or clearest changes in a patient. In education, GenAI hallucinates, makes up events and dates, and creates credible covers for itself, polluting research on the Internet on literally any subject with data utterly unmoored from reality, and confidently, effortlessly wrong.

GenAI is pollution posing as progress. The big companies who invest in it only do so in order to appear 'important' to some process or another, to receive support from a big IPO, to win government contracts; it is pure technical snake oil. There is no value, no democratization, no use whatsoever for this technology in its current state.

I believe in machine learning. I believe that there are good reasons to use neural nets in order to find patterns in otherwise impossibly complicated data. There *are* good uses for synthetic intelligence as a general rule, and I even believe that it is humanity's destiny to create life in this way.

This is not it.

This is theft, exploitation, and the further brutalization of a creative class which has been stripped of any of its former importance. GenAI cannot create or share beauty; it cannot share emotion in the way that humans can, since it has no emotions, no experiences, to share. When AI answers a query like 'why do people pet cats', it can answer with something like 'because it feels good and causes a positive hormone response'; this is true. That said, it has never felt those things; all it has ever done is put an enormous amount of data through a heuristic algorithm at a catastrophic ecological and financial cost (to say nothing of ethics). It can, however, never have pet a cat. It has no experiences; if enough people say something truly insane, or the black box which makes up the GenAI's thought process simply comes up with something unhinged from reality, is it as confident there as ever.

It pollutes our minds. It reduces the impact of our art and writing. It furthers the vicious cycle which says that the only thing that matters is technology, and that art, writing, and the sharing of that which makes us human are all 'not real jobs', or 'fit to be replaced'.

This is not so. Human culture will never come out of a machine in this way, and flattening the soul of our species into bad artwork and queasy, hallucinatory prose impoverishes us all, even GenAI's proponents.

The bubble is bursting: look at how desperate these companies are to be protected from the results of their theft, how Microsoft is pulling back out of many of its GenAI-supporting datacenter acquisitions. Billions upon billions of dollars have been 'used' in the sense that they have been extracted, heaped into a pile, and set on fire for something which doesn't understand even the most basic question, -any- sense of relational or objective reality, or anything else. It is useless. It is harming us. Its creators are stealing from us in order to do it.

I call for nothing less than a ban on generative AI.

There are enough sources of exploitation in our lives; GenAI does nothing but steal from us bigger, faster, and at a far greater cost to our ecosystem, all in the name of building something we call wealth while, in the process, it burns the very natural resources that we cannot replace: drinkable water, fuel, clean air, data and electricity transportation, literally every kind of real resource which humans need to live and thrive.

It's a nightmare. It is the enemy of humanity, not in the sense of some Bollywood Terminator pastiche, but rather as a clear and present danger to our minds, our hearts, our ability to connect to and relate with one another, and the environments in which we live. A real, actual problem, contributing to climate change in order to produce literally nothing of value. It is a machine made to burn money, the result of so many flim-flam men in tech who are grasping at the next 'big' thing, despite the fact that not even one of them has a clue how to continue, or what to do about the existential threats we, not only as a country but as a species, face.